

DAY OF
TERROR

UNTHINKABLE



Suzanne Plunkett/The Associated Press

People run from the collapse of one of the World Trade Center Towers on Tuesday. Both towers crumbled to the ground after two hijacked planes were steered into them.

Death toll likely in thousands; U.S. vows retaliation

TRIBUNE STAFF and NEWS SERVICES

In the wake of the worst attack ever on American civilians, the United States is pointing fingers at Islamic radical Osama bin Laden. The exiled Saudi is believed to be hiding in Afghanistan.

"Today, our nation saw evil," President Bush told the nation about 12 hours after three hijacked commercial airliners hit the heart of America's military and financial capitals, killing perhaps thousands, reducing New York's World Trade Center Towers to stumps of rubble and destroying a portion of the national fortress known as the Pentagon.

Bush vowed to "hunt down and punish" those responsible.

A fourth commandeered airliner, which crashed in western Pennsylvania, was believed headed for Washington. None of the 266 people aboard the two American Airlines and two United Airlines planes survived.

"We will make no distinction between the terrorists who committed these acts and those who harbor them," said Bush,

who, for security reasons, spent much of the day in the air aboard Air Force One, escorted by fighter planes from Florida to Louisiana to Nebraska before returning to Washington, D.C., on Tuesday evening. (The complete text of the president's evening address can be found on Page A-2.)

No official death tally had been announced by press time, but the number of casualties includes about 300 firefighters who responded to the initial crash, and the final number will be "more than any of us can bear," said New York Mayor Rudolph Giuliani.

Bin Laden is blamed for masterminding the bombings of U.S. embassies in Kenya and Tanzania in 1998, and is suspected in the bombing of the USS Cole in Yemen last October. He is believed to be based in Afghanistan. He heads the Al-Qaida, a global terrorist network that has targeted the United States repeatedly.

Sen. Orrin Hatch, R-Utah, a member of the Senate Intelligence Committee,

said Tuesday night "just about everything points" to him.

The loss of life from Tuesday's attacks is likely to be horrendous — as many as 50,000 people could have been in the two 110-story skyscrapers, and thousands in the Pentagon.

The grim toll is almost certain to surpass the 2,403 who were killed in the surprise Japanese attack on the U.S. naval base at Pearl Harbor, Hawaii, on Dec. 7, 1941, and already is greater than the 167 who died in a domestic terrorist bomb attack on a federal building in Oklahoma City on April 19, 1995.

The attack is likely to have a similarly jarring effect on a stunned nation, as Americans hunkered down, suddenly unsure of the safety of their skies and the nation's ability to protect them from faceless enemies. Talk turned quickly to retaliation and even war.

"This is an act of war, and we are at war," proclaimed Sen. Bob Bennett,

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Carmen Taylor/The Associated Press

A jet airliner is lined up on one of the World Trade Center Towers in New York on Tuesday. Both towers crumbled to the ground after two hijacked jets were steered into them in an unprecedented act of terrorism.

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Weather: Scattered showers and thunderstorms around the state; 70s-80s north, 70s-90s south. **D-10**



Attacks Force Review of Olympic Security

BY MICHAEL VIGH and CHRISTOPHER SMITH

THE SALT LAKE TRIBUNE

Tuesday's fiery terrorist attacks will spur Utah's Olympic security planners to scrutinize their strategy for keeping the 2002 Winter Games safe, but they warn the threat of terrorism can never be eliminated.

During next February's Games, Utahns may feel the uncomfortable effects of increased security measures likely to be implemented in the wake of the suicide bombings at the World Trade Center and the Pentagon.

"There is a country in the world which has learned to live under the same threat of terrorism, and that is Israel," said Utah Sen. Bob Bennett. "I expect that the same kinds of heightened

security we see there will be applied to the Olympics. Utahns will find them inconvenient and unfamiliar."

Olympic security experts say Salt Lake City Games organizers' task of balancing the inherent tension between an open society and adequate safety is now more difficult.

"We should do everything we can to increase security, but we don't want to do it at the risk of losing the values of the rest of the country. Otherwise we're going to be stopping cars at the Utah border," said Jack Greene, Northeastern

University's dean of criminal justice.

"One of the unfortunate prices we pay in a free society is a higher level of risk," said Greene, whose research on Olympic security measures is used by organizing committees and the federal government.

Salt Lake Organizing Committee President Mitt Romney met Tuesday with the U.S. Secret Service, which is in charge of Utah's \$200 million Olympic security program.

"I thought the program was a complete and holistic plan, which did not have gaping holes or obvious weaknesses," he told The Associated Press. "I

GAMES AND THREATS

Some Utahns are feeling vulnerable

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